

Reference and Citation in Writing



Number of Authors	In-Text Citation Format	Example
1 Author	(Last Name, Year)	(Smith, 2020)
2 Authors	(Last Name & Last Name, Year)	(Johnson & Carter, 2019)
3+ Authors	(First author et al., Year)	(Martinez et al., 2021)

This is a narrative in-text citation. The author's name is in the text of the sentence. The page number (p. 42) is at the end of the sentence.



Stein (2018) studied whether the early onset of Alzheimer's disease affected individuals younger than 30. His findings revealed that individuals as young as 20 were affected by the disease **(p. 42)**. Another study found similar data, showing that individuals as young as 18 displayed symptoms of the disease **(Tang & Pierce, 2014, p. 231)**. Even though both studies involved individuals in different hemispheres, the results were similar.



This is a parenthetical citation. In parentheses are the last names of the authors, year published, and page number.

In Reference List

1 Author

Last Name, Initial(s). (Year). Title of work. Publisher.

Smith, J. A. (2020). *Urban ecology: Principles and practice*. Green Press.

Last name (surname): Smith
First name: J → Initial for the first name

Middle name: A → Initial for middle name

Full Name is **John Alan Smith** but in the reference list it will be written as **Smith, J. A.**

2 Authors

Last Name, Initial(s)., & Last Name, Initial(s). (Year). Title. Publisher.

Johnson, L. M., & Carter, R. P. (2019). *Sustainable cities and communities*. Urban Press.

3 Authors

Last Name, Initial(s)., Last Name, Initial(s)., & Last Name, Initial(s). (Year). Title. Publisher.

Martinez, J. T., Lee, K. Y., Brown, P. D., & Wilson, S. A. (2021). *Global urban studies*. City Press.



Book Reference

Format: Author, A. A. (Year). *Title of book*: Subtitle. Publisher.

Rules:

- **Author:** Last Name, Initials.
- **Year:** (Year).
- **Title:** Italicized, sentence case.
- **Publisher:** Full publisher name.

- Jan, R. M. A. (2022). *Urban development and sustainability in South Asia*. City Press.



Journal Article Reference

Format: Author, A. A., & Author, B. B. (Year). Title of article. *Journal Name*, Volume(Issue), page range.
<https://doi.org/xxxxxx>

Rules:

- **Article Title:** Sentence case.
- **Journal Name:** Italicized, Title Case.
- **Volume(Issue):** Ital vol. (issue).
- **DOI/URL:** <https://doi.org...>

- Jan, R. M. A. (2021). *Urban resilience to climate change*. *Journal of Environmental Studies*, 35(2), 150–162.
<https://doi.org/10.1234/jes.2021.5678>

Journal Article

author(s) date of publication article title

Aoidh, E. M., Bertolotto, M., & Wilson, D. C. (2012). Towards dynamic behavior-based profiling for reducing spatial information overload in map browsing activity. *GeoInformatica*, 16(3), 409-434. <http://dx.doi.org/10.1007/s10707-011-0137-4>

journal title volume(issue) pages URL or DOI

Book

author(s) date of publication book title

Shotton, M. A. (1989). *Computer addiction? A study of computer dependency*. London: Taylor & Francis.

publisher info

Edited Book

Author, A. A., & Author, B. B. (Copyright Year). *Title of the book (7th ed.)*. Publisher. DOI or URL

Paraphrase:

Ideas from the source, but
written in your own words

In-text citation:

Author's surname and
year of publication

Leadership is different from management as being a manager doesn't mean he/she has the skill to lead. Management means achieving organizational goals in an effective and efficient way (Daft & Pirola-Merlo, 2009). On the other hand, leadership has a different perspective. According to Lussier and Achua (2013), "leadership occurs when followers are influenced to do what is ethical and beneficial for the organization and themselves" (p. 8).

Direct quotation:

Double quotation marks
are used

In-text citation:

Page number must be used
to show the location of a
direct quote.
(optional when paraphrase)

APA 7 Capitalization Rules

1 Titles in Reference List

A Book / Report Titles

- Use sentence case:
 1. The first word of the title
 2. The first word after a **colon** or dash
 3. Proper nouns.
- *Urban development and sustainability in South Asia*
- *The ecology of cities: Challenges and solutions*

B Journal Article Titles

- Use sentence case.
- *Urban green spaces and mental health*

2 In-Text Citation Titles

- ✓ Articles / book chapters → sentence case
 - (“*Climate change in cities*,” 2020)
- ✚ Books/Journals/reports in mentioned in text. *Title case, italicized*
 - *The Ecology of Cities* (Jan, 2022)
- T - Examples: *South Asia*, *Harvard University* and more countries

Quick Reference

Item	Capitalization Rule	Example
Book / Report Title	Sentence case	<i>Urban development and sustainability</i>
Journal Article Title	Sentence case	<i>Urban green spaces and mental health</i>
Journal Name	Title case, italicized	<i>Journal of Urban Ecology</i>
Subtitles	Capitalize first word after colon	<i>The ecology of cities: Challenges and solutions</i>
Proper nouns	Always capitalize	South Asia,
Minor words	Lowercase unless first word or proper noun	<i>and, or, in, the</i>

✓ Tips & Tips

- ✓ If unsure; capitalize the first word, proper nouns, and first word after punctuation in title.
- ✓ Sentence case for articles, chapters, and books in *reference list*; journal book name in text uses *title case italicized*.
- ✓ Check **author names** in references, they always capitalized.



Title will only be used for in-text citation when the author name isn't given.

Guidelines for APA 7th Edition In-Text Citations

Type the link on your browser

https://owl.purdue.edu/owl/research_and_citation/apa_style/apa_formatting_and_style_guide/in_text_citations_the_basics.html

OR

Shortlink:

<https://url-shortener.me/9CLI>

The background is a light cream color with a border of rounded corners. It is decorated with various abstract elements: a purple shape in the top left containing a line drawing of a lightbulb; a green shape in the top right containing a line drawing of a box with a checkmark; a large orange shape in the bottom left containing a line drawing of a face with a vertical line through its center; and a green shape in the bottom right containing a line drawing of a document with horizontal lines and a checkmark. There are also several smaller, solid-colored shapes in purple, green, and orange scattered throughout.

Descriptive writing

Techniques for Descriptive Writing

- **Show, Don't Tell:** Convey feelings through actions and details rather than directly stating them.
- **Use Strong Verbs:** Choose powerful, precise verbs over weak or common ones.
- **Choose Specific Nouns:** Use precise nouns to create clearer and vivid images.
- **Add Figurative Language:** Incorporate similes, metaphors, or personification for expressive writing.
- **Use Prepositional Phrases:** Add details about place, direction, or movement.
- **Organize Description:** Arrange details in a logical, easy-to-follow order.
- **Avoid Too Many Adjectives:** Prefer one strong word instead of multiple weak descriptors.
- **Create Mood & Atmosphere:** Select words that reflect the intended feeling or tone.
- **Vary Sentence Length:** Mix short and long sentences to create rhythm and flow.

Elements of a Descriptive Essay

1

Sensory Details



The writer must paint a vivid scene for each sense so that readers can visualize it in their minds.

2

Figurative Language



It is one of the main elements that help readers feel what was felt by both author and subject alike.

3

Central and Key Theme



The central theme is what links all of your ideas and thoughts together to form an argument.

SENSORY DETAILS



Sight

What does it look like?

vibrant, shimmering, gloomy
dazzling, faded, sparkling
misty, golden, crooked
translucent

The sky turned a gloomy grey before the storm rolled in.



Sound

What does it sound like?

whispering, crackling, humming
thundering, echoing, screeching
buzzing, murmuring, ticking
banging

*The leaves made a **whispering** sound as the wind passed through.*



Smell

What does it smell like?

fragrant, musty, smoky,
earthy, citrusy, rotten
spicy, fresh, salty

*The air smelled a **earthy** after the first rain.*



Taste

What does it taste like?

bitter, tangy, sweet, sour
salty, juicy, bland, spicy
creamy, zesty

*The lemonade was **tangy** and refreshing.*



Touch/Feel

How does it feel?

rough, smooth, sticky, chilly
fuzzy, fuzzy

*The cat's fur was **silky** and soft.*



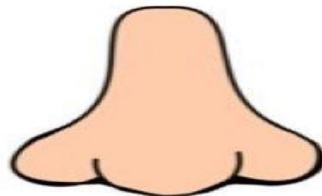
Emotion

What does the character feel inside?

joyful, anxious, peaceful
frustrated, proud
excited, embarrassed

Use these words to paint pictures with your writing.

Example:

Sight	Sound	Touch	Taste	Smell
bleary blurred brilliant colourless dazzling dim dingy faded faint flashy gaudy glance gleaming glimpse glistening glittering gloomy glossy glowing 	bellow blare buzz cackle cheer clamour clang crackle creak grumble gurgle hiss howl hush jabber mumble murmur mutter rant rave roar rumble rustle screech shriek shrill sizzle snarl squawk squeal swish thud thump whimper yelp 	balmy biting bristly bumpy chilly coarse cold cool crawly creepy cuddly dusty feathery feverish fluffy furry fuzzy gooey greasy gritty hairy hot icy limp lumpy moist oily powdery prickly scratchy shivery silky slimy slippery spongy springy squashy sticky sweaty velvety 	appetising bitter bland creamy delectable delicious flavourful flavourless gingery  luscious nauseating palatable peppery piquant refreshing ripe rotten salty savoury scrumptious sharp sour spicy spoiled stale sugary sweet tangy tasteless tasty unappetising unripe vinegary yummy zesty	acrid aroma aromatic fetid foul-smelling fragrant mouldy musty nidorous odiferous odour odourless old perfumed pungent putrid rancid rank reeking scent scented smell  stench spicy sweet waft whiff

Using the Five Senses to Describe



I saw a vibrant pink and yellow rose, heard bees buzzing, smelled the **sweet fragrance**, tasted the crisp morning air, and felt the velvety petals.



I watched the misty woods fade in the distance, **heard leaves rustle**, smelled pine and damp earth, tasted the cool air, and felt the damp moss underfoot.

Flower in Garden



- **Sight:** In the garden, a bright red tulip sways gently,
- **Sound:** as bees hum around it;
- **Smell:** its sweet fragrance fills the air,
- **Touch:** the silky petals invite your touch,
- **Taste:** and you can almost taste the nectar lingering in it bloom.

1

Sunny Beach



- **Sight:** On the sunny beach, golden sand stretches to meet the sparkling blue sea,
- **Sound:** where waves crash rhythmically.
- **Smell:** and the salty breeze fills the air;
- **Touch:** warm sand slips between your toes,
- **Taste:** leaving the tang of salt on your lips.

2

Fresh Apple on Table



- **Sight:** Resting on the table, a shiny red apple catches the light,
- **Sound:** and as you bite into it, a crisp snap echoes,
- **Smell:** while its sweet aroma rises;
- **Touch:** the firm, cool skin feels smooth in your hand.
- **Taste:** and the juicy, tart flavor bursts with every taste.

3

Techniques to Write a Strong Introduction

Start with a Hook

- Begin with a short, engaging story, memory, or visual description to immediately capture the reader's attention.

Use **sensory details**: sight, sound, smell, touch, or movement.

Provide Context or Background

- Give a brief explanation of why the topic is important or meaningful.
- Connect the hook to the main idea without giving away all the details.

Write a Clear Thesis Statement

- Include the **three main supporting points** you will describe in the body paragraphs.
- Make it **specific, linked, and real-life**, not just a general description.
- Use **transition words** to connect the points smoothly.

Add a Transitional Hook

- End the introduction with a sentence that **links the thesis to the body paragraphs**.
- Start with **transitional words** like: *Thus, Consequently, Therefore, In turn, Accordingly* etc. (if needed).

Use Linked and Coherent Sentences

- Make sure every sentence flows into the next.
- Use **connectors and linking phrases**: moreover, in addition, as well as, furthermore, meanwhile etc.
- Avoid abrupt jumps; the reader should **move smoothly from hook → background → thesis → transitional hook**.



A Cultural Event That Left a Lasting Impression

Last autumn, I attended the lantern festival, and as hundreds of glowing lanterns floated into the night sky, the streets came alive with music, laughter, and the excited chatter of families and friends. The festivals like this not only preserve cultural traditions but also bring communities together, creating shared memories that linger long after the celebration ends. This festival was unforgettable because of the dazzling displays of lights and colors that captivated every eye, the lively music and spirited interactions that energized the crowd, and the joy and sense of unity that filled everyone present, making the experience deeply memorable. From the very first lantern rising gracefully into the sky to the collective cheer of the crowd, every moment of the festival celebrated both heritage and togetherness.

My Favorite Restaurant

Walking into my favorite Italian restaurant, I was instantly enveloped by the aroma of freshly baked bread and simmering sauces, while warm lights and rustic décor welcomed me inside. A restaurant is more than just a place to eat because it can create lasting memories through its ambiance, food, and hospitality. This restaurant is unforgettable because of its cozy decor and inviting atmosphere that makes every visit feel special, the attentive service and lively environment that create a sense of comfort, and the comforting flavors of each dish that leave a lasting impression on both heart and taste buds. Thus, with each bite of homemade pasta and every shared laugh across the table, the restaurant becomes a complete sensory and emotional experience.